Fiscal Year:	FY 2020	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 07/12/2019
PI Name:	Yu, Nan Ph.D.		
Project Title:	JPL Participation in ESA ACES (Atomic Clock Ensemble in Space) Worldwide Clock Comparison Campaign		
Division Name:	Physical Sciences		
Program/Discipline:	FUNDAMENTAL PHYSICS		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	FUNDAMENTAL PHYSICS--Fundamental physics		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
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City:	Pasadena	**State:**	CA
Zip Code:	91109-8001	**Congressional District:**	27
Comments:			
Project Type:	Flight	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2010 Fundamental Physics Rapid Turn Around Flight Opportunity
Start Date:	10/01/2010	**End Date:**	05/31/2023
No. of Post Docs:	1	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	0	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	0	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA JPL
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Flight Program:	ISS		
Flight Assignment:	ISS NOTE: Changed JPL Task Plan number to 71-15884 per U. Israelsson/JPL (Ed., 5/27/2020) NOTE: End date changed to 5/31/2023 per U. Israelsson/JPL (Ed., 1/28/2020) NOTE: End date changed to 11/29/2019 per PI (Ed., 2/13/18) NOTE: End date changed to 3/31/2018 per PI (Ed., 2/19/15)		
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	For the period of FY2018 and part of FY2019: Key personnel during the reporting period includes Tigran Kalaydzhyan, Makan Mohageg, Eric Burt, Robert Tjoelker, Vladmir Schkolnik, Jason Williams, and James Kohel		
COI Name (Institution):	Tjoelker, Robert Ph.D. (Jet Propulsion Laboratory) Burt, Eric Ph.D. (Jet Propulsion Laboratory)		
Grant/Contract No.:	JPL Task Plan number 71-15884 ; JPL Task Plan number 71-15743		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:	Tremendous progress has been made recently in the U.S. and other countries in advancing atomic clock technology and its applications for the benefit of science, national interests, and society in general. Space provides a unique environment in which many benefits can be realized. The European Space Agency (ESA) is readying the ACES (Atomic Clock Ensemble in Space) payload for the International Space Station (ISS) for an anticipated 2013 launch. Some of the key objectives of ACES will be achieved by global time transfer and clock comparisons with the most advanced clocks at multiple worldwide sites. There is an opportunity for investigators from the leading U.S. clock and metrology labs to participate in the clock comparison campaign, enhancing the overall science objective of ACES and at the same time demonstrating and providing science benefit from advanced U.S. clock technology. The Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL) is one of the major U.S. time and frequency metrology institutions serving NASA missions and Deep Space Network needs. It was the NASA center for the microgravity LCAP program (Laser Cooling and Atomic Physics) in charge of developing the cold atom clock payload for PARCS (Primary Atomic Reference Clock in Space). JPL has also developed a unique atomic frequency standard that has demonstrated an exceptional long-term stability. We propose to collaborate with ESA on the ACES mission by participating in the ACES global clock campaign with JPL's ultra-stable mercury ion clock. During a proposed six-year performance period, we will: 1) contribute significantly to the ACES mission science objectives by providing unique clock references from a Western U.S. site; 2) provide and demonstrate a high-impact application for JPL's high performance time keeping clock technology; and 3) re-establish NASA's involvement in ISS Clock Science and initiate a healthy collaboration between NASA and ESA in the area of clock and quantum sensors. The task is to collaborate with ESA on the ACES mission by participating in the ACES global clock comparison campaign and provide frequency and time references derived from JPL's ultra-stable mercury ion clock. These references will be connected to a microwave link ground terminal provided by ACES and installed at JPL. Clock comparisons will be carried out over the microwave link with ESA clocks on the ISS. As JPL is the only ground comparison site located in the western USA and the mercury ion clock is the only one of its kind in the global clock comparison campaign, JPL's participation will contribute significantly to the overall ACES mission science objectives, while simultaneously providing a high-impact application for JPL's high performance time keeping clock technology. The task will also help re-establish NASA's involvement in ISS clock science and enable future collaboration between NASA and ESA in the area of clocks and quantum sensors.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	Advanced atomic clocks are critical to the interests of NASA and the nation. Telecommunication and navigation (e.g., GPS) are well-known applications of space clocks. Within NASA, high performance atomic clocks and frequency and timing capabilities enable operation of the NASA Deep Space Network and provide fundamental tools for precise measurements exploring the laws of Nature. Progress in advanced clock technology development, both on ground and for space, is rapidly being made in many countries. Participation by the U.S. in the ACES mission contributes to the science objectives of the ISS consistent with the 2011 National Research Council (NRC) report recommendations in Fundamental physics and demonstrates the capability and potential of NASA mercury ion clock technology. It will also help advances the clock development and operational capabilities at JPL/NASA.
Task Progress:	Before the ACES clock payload is launched to ISS, the JPL's effort has been in three main areas: upgrading the JPL ground clocks, preparation and installation of the microwave link ground terminal at JPL site, and investigation of ACES clock science. In the past years, the focus has been more on the first two. We have completed the ground terminal site preparation and are ready to receive the ESA ground terminal to be installed at JPL. The ground clock upgrading effort has since shifted to the highly leveraged development of two mercury ion clocks of the next generation for the JPL frequency Standard Test Lab. While waiting for ACES ground terminal to be delivered and installed, and the ACES payload launches into ISS, we have been focusing on science investigation as well as added contributing ground optical clocks from the leveraged works. In this reporting period, we have continued the investigations using ACES clocks and similar space clock arrays for detection of ultra-light dark matter fields. New limits of the dark matter fields can be placed based on the anticipated ACES clock comparison data. A second paper has been published on the subject. At the same time, we have developed a set of data analysis tools to process the expected ACES mission science data once in operation. In addition, the leveraged Sr lattice optical clock experiment is at its final stage of preparing cold atoms into the lattice. We expect it in operation at the time of ACES operation. The baseline ground mercury ion locks are being continuously evaluated and improved. The clock ensemble at JPL is ready for participating in the ACES operation and global clock comparison campaign.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 10/28/2020)
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Kalaydzhyan T, Yu N. "Searching for stochastic background of ultra-light fields with atomic sensors." Universe. 2018 Oct;4(10):99. 19 p. ISSN 2218-1997 https://doi.org/10.3390/universe4100099 , Oct-2018